



A foundation layer for the HR profession, and the people it supports

Growth With Tech and Humans. AI suggests, humans decide.

Conversation with Lizzie Crowley, CIPD skills adviser
Thursday 20 August 2026, 11:00 | David Uccelli, founder, gwth.ai



What GWTH is

A three-month, practical AI course for working adults in the UK. Built to be done in five hours a week, with a project in every lesson.

3 months,
5 hrs a week

96 lessons: 66
core,
30 optional by
role

1 practical project
in every lesson

3 capstone apps
you keep

Month 1 From zero to building

AI for your own life and job. The six things AI is good at: research, content, thinking, building, data, automation. Capstone: Family AI Bot.

Month 2 Building real apps

Work and small-business use: apps, workflows, consulting. Optional lessons by role (HR, finance, building). Capstone: AI customer-support chatbot.

Month 3 Enterprise AI and agents

Transformation, governance, change management, team structures, managing agents. Capstone: AI readiness assessment tool for a whole organisation.

Also: Model Arena labs (live side-by-side model comparisons, free). A verifiable record of what you built, which decays if you stop keeping current. UK examples throughout. No coding required. £29 a month for three months, then £7.50 a month to stay current. Beta is free.

Why I set it up

It started two years ago as the course I wanted for myself. People kept asking for it, so it became a real one.

The gap I kept running into

- Most of what is on offer is one of two things: a 20-minute awareness video from a US vendor, or a university course on how to build a large language model. Almost nobody needs either.
- Much of it is one to three years old, and in AI that is a different era. Anything that is not updated continuously is teaching the wrong thing.
- Little of it is written from a UK point of view: UK tax, UK law, UK employers, UK public services.
- Hardly any of it asks you to build something, and none of it gives you proof that still means something six months later.

So GWTH was built to be

- 1 Affordable for everyone**
You know what you pay and what you get. The price drops once the teaching is done.
- 2 Practical and proven**
You build in every lesson, keep what you build, and the record is verifiable by an employer.
- 3 Kept current**
Around ten lessons refreshed every month. The record decays if you do not keep up, on purpose.
- 4 Independent and plain-spoken**
No sponsors, no vendor curriculum, British English, no hype. Built by a UK solution architect with 25 years in enterprise software.

How it benchmarks against the government AI hub

Your honest view on this is the thing I most want from today. Here is how I see it.

	AI Skills Hub (Boost + Marketplace)	GWTH
Who made it	Mostly US vendors: Google, Microsoft, Amazon, IBM	Independent, UK-built, vendor-neutral
Depth	20 minutes to 9 hours per course	120+ hours over three months
Hands-on	Mostly watch-and-click	A project in every lesson, three capstone apps
Currency	Some content years old	Continuous updates; the record decays if you stop
Proof	Completion badge	Verifiable record of work, currentness built in
UK context	Generic	UK examples, law, tax, public services
Finding it	600+ listings to choose from	One path, with optional lessons by role

Context: 21% of UK workers feel confident using AI at work (DSIT, published Jan 2026, fieldwork 2024). 29% of UK businesses used at least one AI technology in June 2026 (ONS, July 2026). The hub has the reach; the question is whether the content changes either number.

What I took from the 27 July call with CIPD

CIPD is rebuilding its AI learning around 14 products, mostly virtual classroom and face-to-face. The gap is underneath them.

"We're getting people coming in thinking they're better than they are, or with different fundamental understandings to other people in the room."

The baseline problem before any classroom course

"Something like what you've shown here could be a fantastic precursor to people going on some of those courses."

GWTH as the foundation layer

"It's a real danger that we miss that building block, that foundational skill level and thinking level that needs to underpin all that practice."

The risk Steve is taking into his October plan

"The reason you're a CIPD member is because we can lift you up with really trusted, high quality support."

Ben, on why a member benefit could fit

Also agreed: CIPD does not promote other organisations' work, but a member benefit is a membership decision; Steve and I reconvene late October / early November once the new CEO has set direction; NDA plus a demo account for Steve to review the full syllabus.

Ben's four objectives, mapped to the course

From Ben's message of 12 August. The content is there; what changes is the framing and the path through it.

CIPD wants to help...	Where it lives in GWTH today	What a CIPD edition adds
members use AI to do their HR roles better	Month 1: the six things AI is good at, applied to your own job; every lesson ends in a built, kept artefact	HR-flavoured examples and projects chosen from the existing bank; the first lab is already 'Write a job advert: Claude vs ChatGPT'
HR functions become more efficient while managing people risks such as discrimination, as operating models change	Months 2 and 3: workflows and apps for the function; governance, change management, how teams and managers change when people manage agents	A CIPD-curated 'responsible use and people risk' strand written with CIPD guidance, kept current on the same monthly cycle
HR directors and OD lead responsible, integrated AI adoption across the business	Month 3: enterprise AI, agents, self-hosted AI, ROI; capstone is an AI readiness assessment of a whole organisation	A senior-leader path: the Month 3 core as the pre-read before CIPD's strategy and leading-implementation courses
organisations upskill their whole workforce to use AI in their jobs	The whole course is role-agnostic by design; the Teams dashboard assigns optional lessons per role and tracks completion	Members and their employers join through CIPD; each record shows the level reached before a classroom course

The idea: from 'Teams' to 'Curated by CIPD'

Teams already gives an employer its own dashboard and a choice of optional lessons. A curated edition turns that into a co-branded path a partner shapes.

CIPD edition (wrapper)

Co-branded GWTH and CIPD. CIPD framing pages, CIPD research woven in, member pricing.

Curated paths (Teams engine)

Which lessons are core for an HR practitioner, an HRD, a recruiter; which optional lessons are switched on; the record shows the baseline reached.

GWTH core

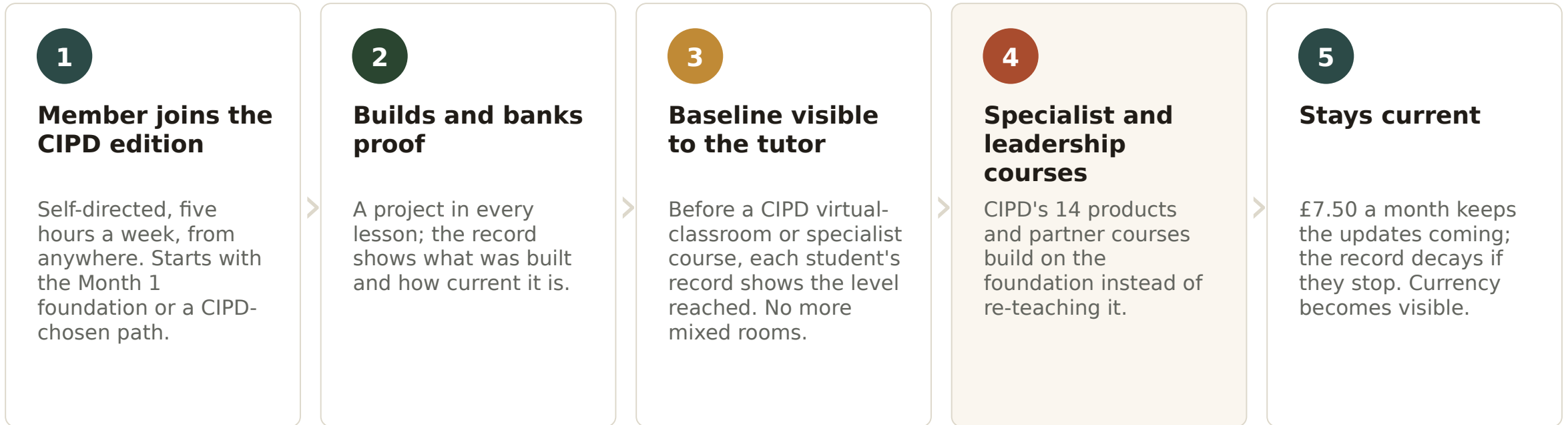
96 lessons, labs, projects, the record, monthly updates. One body of content, maintained once, served through every wrapper.

What CIPD would control

-  **Look** Co-branded so it reads as CIPD-curated
-  **Path** Which lessons are core per HR role, which are optional; a senior-leader path
-  **Voice** CIPD framing at the start of each month, CIPD research and guidance cited inside lessons
-  **People** Member access and pricing
-  **Proof** The certificate says the student took the CIPD pathway
-  **Hand-off** Each path ends by pointing to the matching CIPD or partner course

A foundation for CIPD and partner courses

The flow Steve described: people arrive on a classroom course at a known level, and stay current afterwards.



Why this works for CIPD: CIPD keeps its market (classroom, face-to-face, associates who stay current) and plugs the two gaps Steve named, the baseline and responsible use, without building and maintaining self-directed content. Why it works for GWTH: distribution to the profession that most needs it, and a trusted name on the door.

What I would value from you

Ben said you know the hub well and are well connected in skills policy. Four things I would like to ask.

1 An objective benchmark

Where does GWTH sit against the hub's courses, honestly? What is missing, what is wrong, what would you cut?

2 The route onto the hub

Who lists courses on the government AI skills hub, on what criteria, and is there room for a UK independent course?

3 Policy contacts

Anyone in the skills-policy world who should see a UK, affordable, practical, continuously updated course, including around CIPD's AI adoption research.

4 A member-benefit view

If the CIPD edition were ready, what would the membership team need to see to consider it?

In return: beta access is free, and a full demo account under NDA is yours and Steve's to go through the whole syllabus.

Possible next steps

Fast and concrete. Nothing here needs a decision from CIPD today.

Step 1

Build the CIPD-curated edition prototype: co-branding, an HR path, a senior-leader path, the CIPD pathway on the certificate.

Step 2

Show it to Ben and Lizzie; fold in today's benchmark feedback; NDA and demo account for Steve to review the full syllabus.

Step 3

Soft launch with friends, then the waitlist. Feedback from real use before anything is promoted.

Step 4

Late October / early November: reconvene with Steve once the new CEO has set direction; the baseline gap is in his October plan.

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